



3G with netbooks

As netbooks get smaller, the inevitable has happened. 3G broadband services may start to bundle connections with netbooks, in a similar fashion to the current bundling strategy with phones, according to Pyramid research



Ionic cooling

Tessera is working on a revolutionary new way of cooling laptops with ionic wind

Laptop accessories...

...for travelling



Surge protector

Travellers often have to use dubious electrical connections. A sudden change in voltage can fry the components of a laptop, or damage the data. To protect your laptop and your data, it is a good idea to pick up a surge protector. Instead of purchasing a cheap one for around Rs. 350, pick up the more reliable ones that start from Rs. 750. If you are travelling overseas, it's a good idea to choose a surge protector that is designed to work for different source voltages. Surge protectors also come with connectors for telephones and ethernet cables. Some surge protectors have just one port, and are ultra-portable. Since you are bound to have a few gadgets with you, it's better to choose variants which have anywhere between four and eight outputs.

Security cable

A security cable is a length of steel chord, along with a lock that prevents your laptop from theft. There is a security slot available in most laptops, which is used by the security cable. Some cables use a standard lock and key, while others have a combination lock. Choose one with cabling that is as long as possible, which gives you greater versatility when it comes to locking your laptop down.



Universal adapter

A common frustration that travellers face is to go hunting in the local markets for plugs that will allow them to connect their devices to the power sockets at their local hotels. A universal adapter is a plug that can dock into any socket. These can be made up of a number of plugs, or one plug with pins that slide out. The multiple-plug design is not recommended as the individual components are bound to get lost. The design with the slide out pins is preferable. These have sockets where any kind of plug can be connected; and up to four sliding sets of pins in the front, depending on the type of power outlet you have.



Cooling pad

Those who use their laptops for long periods of time are bound to experience what is known as "lap burn". This is when the laptop heats up to uncomfortable levels. The best way to cool the laptop is to use a cooling pad. There are a wide variety of cooling pads available in the market. The cheaper ones are just sheets of aluminum, acting as a heat sink. The costlier variations however, have fans built into them, which actively cool the laptop. It is preferable to pick up one made of aluminum rather than one made of fabric or plastic, as aluminum is more effective as a heat sink.



Multiple headphone jack

If you are using your laptop to play a movie or for listening to music while traveling, the chances are that ambient noise is going to drown out the music. Consequently, you are likely to play at as high a volume as possible, which is going to drain the laptop rapidly. The best way to combat this is to use a multiple headphone jack. Ones with two or three are pretty common. Shown here is the Belkin Rockstar, which allows up to five headphones to connect to it. Of course, it's a good idea to carry along some headphones as well.

